Practice workbook · Sampling methods

Random, stratified, volunteer and opportunity sampling from a target population.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-03

1. Question 2 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

2 Jenna investigated whether stress affected performance on a memory test.

She recruited 10 participants from her university. Participants were asked to remember a list of 20 words. Fifteen minutes later, they were asked to write down as many words as they could remember. The same participants were tested twice:

- Test 1: one week before their examinations began.
- Test 2: one week after their examinations had finished.

(a) Describe how Jenna could use an opportunity sampling method to gather the participants for her investigation.

(2)

(b) State which experimental research design Jenna used in her investigation.

(1)

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1. Question 2 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 3 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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3 Becca wants to find out if there are sex differences in male and female brain functioning. She decides to use a laboratory experiment.

(a) State **one** feature of a 'laboratory experiment'.

(1)

(b) Describe how Becca could use volunteer sampling to gather the participants for her laboratory experiment.

(2)

(c) Becca will give each participant a coordination task and a word-meaning task to test for sex differences in brain functioning. She decides to use a single-blind technique.

Describe **one** reason why Becca used a single-blind technique for her experiment.

(2)

(d) Becca conducted her laboratory experiment with 30 male and 25 female participants.

Calculate the ratio of male to female participants in Becca's sample.

(1)

Ratio .....

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2. Question 3 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 2 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

2 Yolanda is conducting an observation of children's play in an early years day care setting. She observed children in the setting for four hours on a Monday.

(a) Define what is meant by an 'observation'.

(1)

(b) Describe how Yolanda could have used an opportunity sampling technique to select the children for her observation.

(2)

(c) Yolanda recorded the number of children who played with the different types of toys in the day care setting.

There were a total of 74 children recorded:

- 23 of the total children played with vehicles
- 11 of the total children played with dolls
- 29 of the total children played with role-play toys.

The remaining children played with arts and crafts toys.

(i) Calculate the ratio of children who played with dolls to those who played with arts and crafts toys.

(2)

Ratio .....

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3. Question 2 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 3 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

3 Juliet investigated whether there was a relationship between the number of hours spent using social media and self-rated body image scores.

Firstly, Juliet interviewed a sample of 17-year-old students using a structured interview method, where she asked them to state the length of time they spent on social media per day.

Juliet then asked the same participants to complete a questionnaire to rate how happy they were with their appearance, with a score of 0 being 'very unhappy' and 10 being 'very happy'.

(a) Define what is meant by a 'structured interview'.

(1)

(b) Describe how Juliet could have used a random sampling technique for her investigation.

(2)

(c) Identify the type of data Juliet gathered in her investigation.

(1)

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4. Question 3 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 2 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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2 Jason is planning to use a questionnaire to investigate whether there is a difference in the use of social media by people of different ages.

(a) Give **one** open-ended question and **one** closed-ended question that Jason could use in his questionnaire.

(2)

Open-ended question

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Closed-ended question

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5. Question 2 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Describe how Jason could use a stratified sampling technique to gather his participants.

(2)

(c) Jason will gather qualitative data from his questionnaire.

Define what is meant by 'qualitative data'.

(1)

(Total for Question 2 = 5 marks)

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Working and answer